

How I Deliver the Pre-Sales Process: A Full-Lifecycle, Commercially-Driven Approach

I deliver the pre-sales process as a structured, commercially disciplined workflow that transforms an initial client opportunity into a fully validated, costed, risk-managed, contract-ready solution. My approach blends bid leadership, technical solutioning, service design, and commercial governance to ensure proposals are compelling, feasible, and profitable.

1. Responding to Bids & Tenders

I begin by analysing the client's RFP/RFI, clarifying scope, constraints, evaluation criteria, and win themes. This includes coordinating clarifications, shaping the response strategy, and establishing the delivery model required to win.

- Opportunity qualification
 - Bid/no-bid assessment
 - Response structure and compliance mapping
 - Win-theme development
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2. Requirements Gathering & Discovery

Through structured workshops, interviews, and artefact reviews, I extract functional, technical, operational, and commercial requirements.

- User journeys
- Business processes
- Technical constraints
- Integration needs
- Non-functional requirements

This ensures the solution is grounded in real client needs rather than assumptions.

3. Solution Design & Service Design

I lead the creation of the end-to-end solution architecture and operating model, covering:

- Application, data, and integration architecture

- Service management model (ITIL-aligned)
- Support tiers, SLAs, OLAs
- Operational processes and tooling
- Security, identity, and compliance considerations

This produces a coherent, scalable, supportable solution.

4. Cost Modelling & Resource Modelling

I build detailed commercial models that reflect:

- Delivery effort (T&M or fixed price)
- Resource profiles and utilisation
- Third-party costs
- Infrastructure and licensing
- Support and run-costs
- Margin, revenue, and profitability targets

Models are validated with SMEs, finance teams, and delivery leads to ensure accuracy and viability.

5. CADRO Identification

I run a full CADRO analysis to ensure the solution is risk-aware and commercially protected:

- Constraints — technical, regulatory, operational
- Assumptions — client responsibilities, data availability, access
- Dependencies — suppliers, integrations, environments
- Risks — delivery, commercial, operational
- Opportunities — value-adds, efficiencies, upsell
- Limitations — scope boundaries, exclusions

CADRO feeds directly into the SoW, commercials, and governance.

6. Supplier Management, Procurement & Logistics

I coordinate supplier engagement, ensuring:

- Quotes and lead times

- Technical validation
- Commercial alignment
- Contractual compliance
- Logistics and delivery planning

This ensures third-party components are costed, feasible, and aligned to the client timeline.

7. Statement of Work Creation & Legal Review

I produce a contract-ready SoW that includes:

- Scope and deliverables
- Acceptance criteria
- Responsibilities
- CADRO
- Commercials
- Change control
- Governance

Legal review ensures alignment with contractual obligations, IP, liability, and compliance.

8. Technical Workshops & Business Case Management

I run deep-dive workshops to validate the solution and support the client's internal approval process. This includes:

- Architecture walkthroughs
- Service model validation
- Operational readiness
- Cost justification
- ROI modelling

I help shape the client's business case to ensure internal sponsorship and budget approval.

9. BAFO, Pricing Models & Negotiation

During Best and Final Offer (BAFO), I refine:

- Pricing (fixed price, T&M, hybrid)
- Delivery phasing
- Risk positions
- Commercial concessions
- Value-adds

I lead negotiation sessions to secure a commercially viable and mutually beneficial agreement.

10. Client Presentation & Planning Workshops

I deliver executive-grade presentations that clearly articulate:

- Solution value
- Delivery roadmap
- Commercials
- Risks and mitigations
- Governance
- Benefits and outcomes

Planning workshops ensure the client understands how mobilisation will work from day one.

11. Meeting Revenue & Margin Requirements

Throughout the process, I maintain strict commercial discipline:

- Revenue targets
- Retained margin
- Cost control
- Risk mitigation
- Scope protection

This ensures the proposal is not only winnable but profitable and deliverable.

Conclusion

My pre-sales approach is a full-lifecycle, commercially governed, technically robust process that transforms opportunities into contract-ready solutions. It

balances client value, technical feasibility, and commercial rigour, ensuring every bid is competitive, deliverable, and profitable.